Cartoon Analysis Andrew Mc Neel

This cartoon by Andrew McMeel was published in 2023 by the cartoon collections company. It shows todays society with social media and wether it is social or not.

First of all, we can see in the middle of the picture are two men standing probably archeologists, standing and looking at an ancient wall. In the background, there are icons of several social media apps carved into the stone of the wall. We can also see hyroglyphs carved into the same wall as well, that shows how far in the future the scene plays. The man on the left gathers our civilization to be very advanced, intelligent and social. The man to the right on the other hand is not so sure about that. On the right, there is also a what looks like a door. In the other chamber there are also some glyphs carved into the wall.

The core message of this cartoon is even with social media, our civilization is not that social as it thinks it is. In todays society we tend to over- and underestimate a lot of things. The same thing happens to social media, as we can see in the cartoon. As we do it, the man on the left has a first thought about our culture. He thinks we're very intelligent and socialized because of all the apps we have. With those apps we can call anybody around the globe in less than 3 seconds. Every single human is able to do so with a phone. Only two centuries ago that would have been impossible. Furthermore we can share our lifestyle, culture, habits, recipes and so on, which should tell that we are 100% socialised. On the second look that's not a 100% correct. The man on the right tells us that he is not sure about our level of intelligence and socialisation. He is totally right, we can know everything about anybody, but that's too much for humans and we, instead of having a good balance,consume much more on social media, and isolate ourselves. That leads to depression, anxiety and other psychological diseases. Furthermore we put false images of people and compare them with us which can end in bad sport eating or exercising habits.

In conclusion we can say that the message of the cartoon is one we shouldn't ignore. It is now more important than ever before to know the bad sides of social media and the author did a great job showing us.

In my own opinion, I can only agree with this cartoon because I suffered for some time for exactly that reason. So, it is a very important topic to me. The author did a great job telling us the message, and I really like the metaphor with the archaeologists looking back to us and figuring out how we were because that's exactly what we're doing with ancient cultures today.